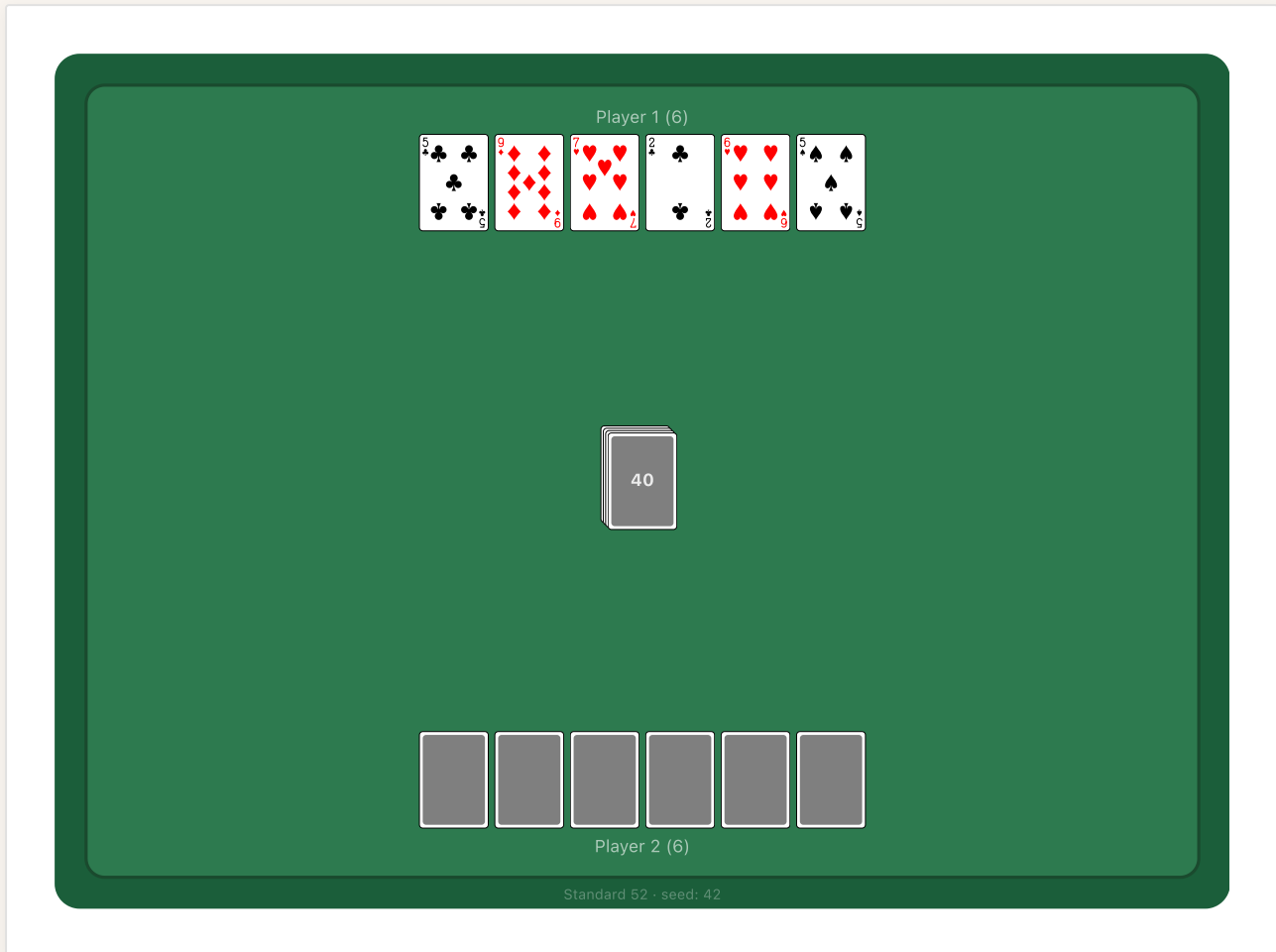


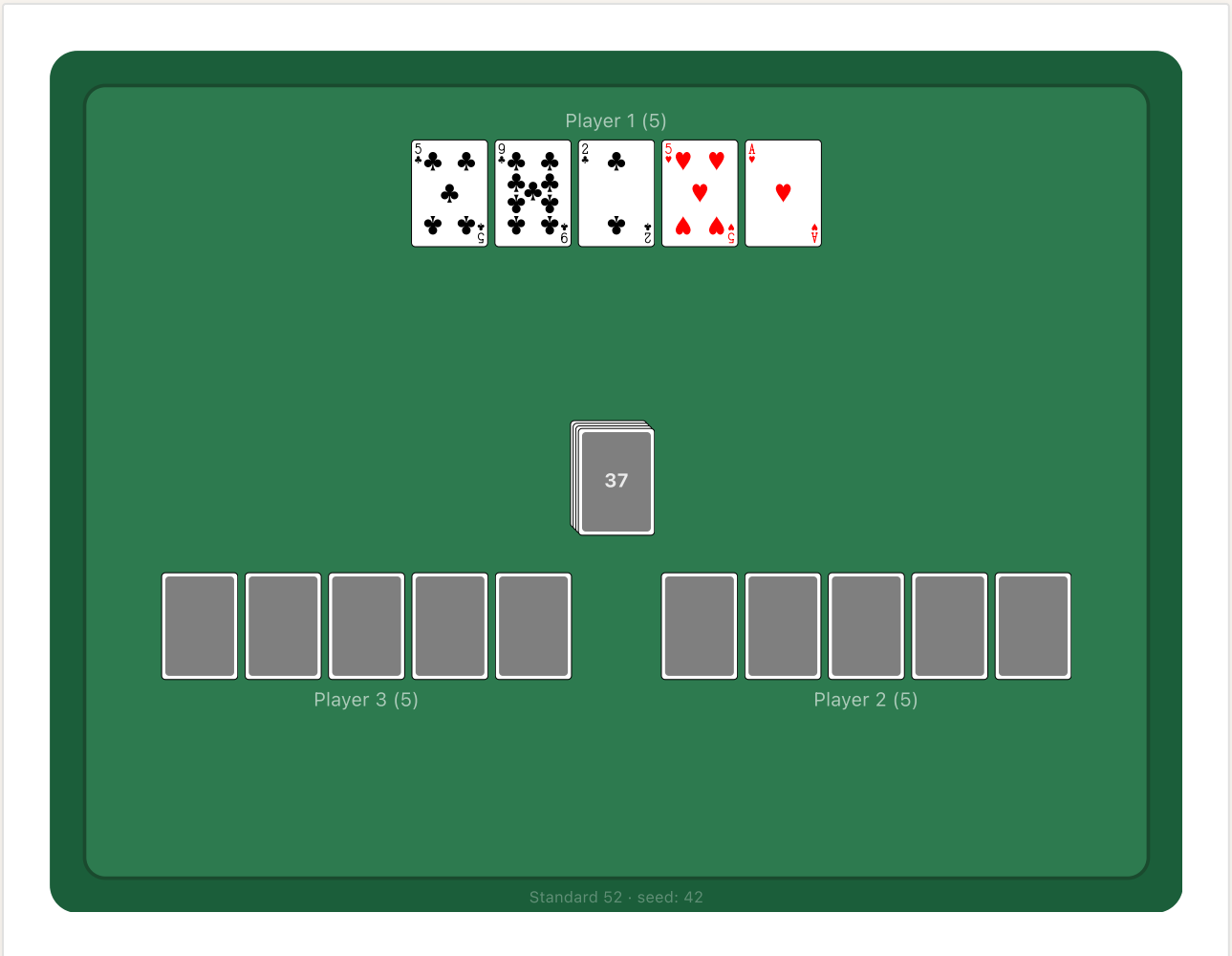
# CRIBBAGE

Cribbage is a two-player card game in which the primary goal is to be the first to peg 121 points on a cribbage board. Points are scored in three phases: the deal (crib), the pegging phase (playing out cards alternately), and the show (hand counting after play). Attributed to the poet Sir John Suckling (England, early 17th century).



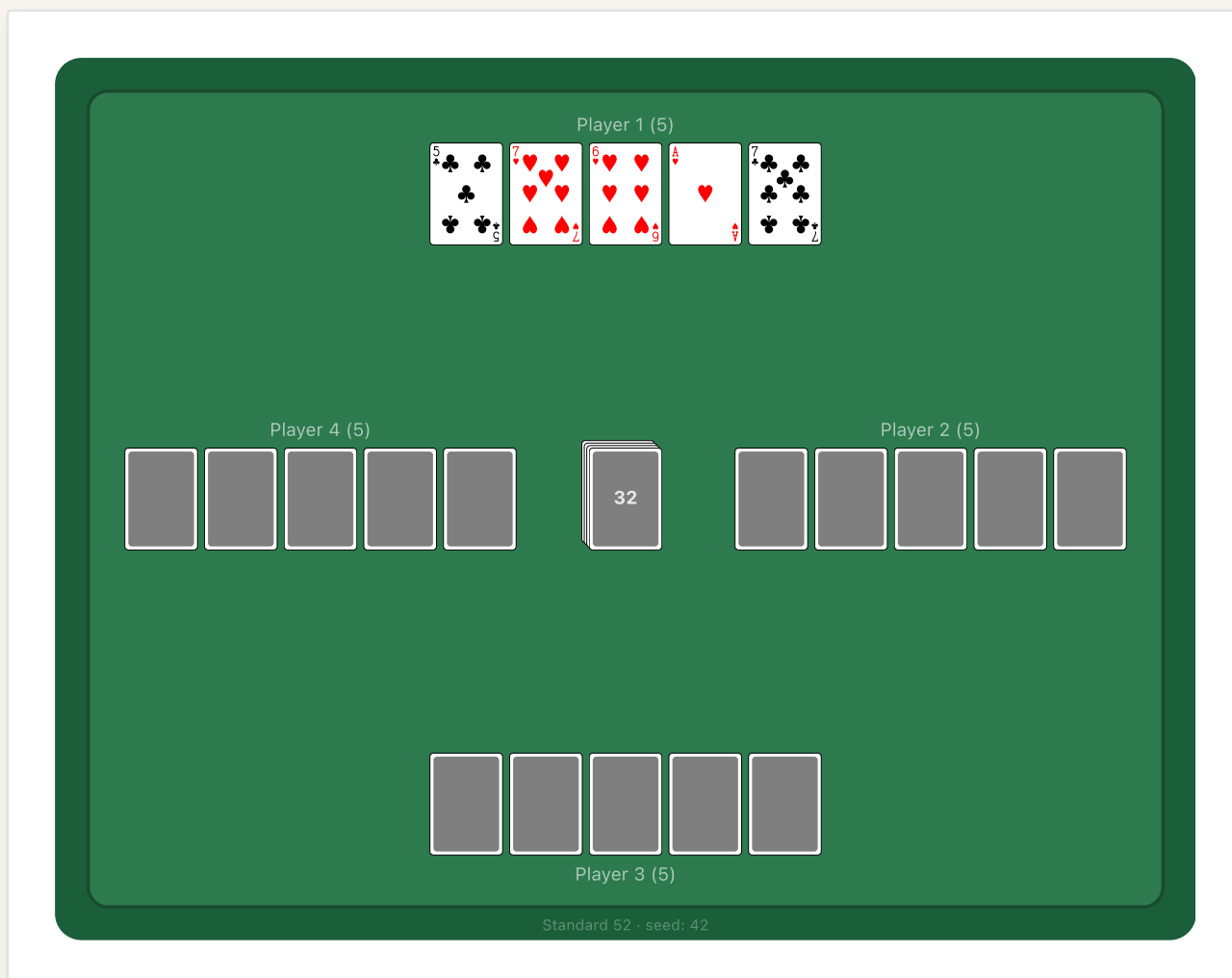
*Cribbage — table layout*

<https://engine.moddable.games/play/?game=standard-52&variant=cribbage>



*Cribbage — three-player layout*

<https://engine.moddable.games/play/?game=standard-52&variant=cribbage>



*Cribbage — four-player layout*

<https://engine.moddable.games/play/?game=standard-52&variant=cribbage>

## THE CRIBBAGE BOARD

Each player has a track of 120 holes (pegging twice around a 60-hole board) plus a game hole at 121. Two pegs per player allow tracking from 0 to 121. The game ends immediately when any player's front peg reaches or passes hole 121.

## CARD VALUES

- ♦ **Number cards (A–10):** Face value (Ace = 1).
- ♦ **Face cards (J, Q, K):** All worth 10.
- ♦ **Ranking** (for sequences and cutting): A, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, J, Q, K (Ace is always low).

## DEAL

Deal 6 cards each. Each player discards 2 cards face-down to the crib — a second hand owned by the dealer. The crib is scored by the dealer at the end of the round.

**Strategy note:** The non-dealer (pone) generally avoids giving good cards to the crib; the dealer welcomes strong crib contributions.

## THE CUT (STARTER CARD)

After discarding, the non-dealer cuts the remaining deck. The dealer reveals the top card of the lower half — this is the **starter card** (also called the turn-up). It is used in scoring all hands during the show.

**Nibs (Heels):** If the starter card is a Jack, the dealer immediately pegs 2 points (“Two for his heels”).

## PEGGING PHASE

Alternating starting with the non-dealer, players lay cards one at a time face-up, calling out the cumulative running total (never exceeding 31).

**Pegging scores during play:**

| EVENT                                                | POINTS |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Reaching exactly 15 (cumulative total)               | 2      |
| Reaching exactly 31                                  | 2      |
| “Go” (opponent cannot play without exceeding 31)     | 1      |
| Last card played (if total is not 31)                | 1      |
| Pair (consecutive same-rank card)                    | 2      |
| Three of a kind (three consecutive same rank)        | 6      |
| Four of a kind (four consecutive same rank)          | 12     |
| Run of 3 (consecutive ranks in last 3+ cards played) | 3      |
| Run of 4                                             | 4      |
| Run of 5                                             | 5      |

**Go rule:** When a player cannot play without exceeding 31, they say “Go.” The opponent continues playing cards if they can. After a Go (or when 31 is reached), the running total resets to 0 and the player who did not last play begins a new sequence.

## THE SHOW (HAND SCORING)

After pegging, players score their hands using the starter card as a fifth card. The pone (non-dealer) scores first, then the dealer, then the dealer scores the crib.

**Scoring combinations (each combination scores separately):**

| COMBINATION                                            | POINTS          | NOTES                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Fifteen:</b> Any combination of cards summing to 15 | 2 per fifteen   | Ace=1, J/Q/K=10                                                          |
| <b>Pair:</b> Two cards of the same rank                | 2 per pair      |                                                                          |
| <b>Pair Royal (Three of a kind):</b>                   | 6 (three pairs) |                                                                          |
| <b>Double Pair Royal (Four of a kind):</b>             | 12 (six pairs)  |                                                                          |
| <b>Run of 3:</b> Three cards in sequence               | 3               |                                                                          |
| <b>Run of 4:</b> Four cards in sequence                | 4               |                                                                          |
| <b>Run of 5:</b> Five cards in sequence                | 5               |                                                                          |
| <b>Flush (4 cards same suit in hand):</b>              | 4               | Starter card not required. Not counted in crib unless all 5 cards match. |
| <b>Flush (5 cards same suit, including starter):</b>   | 5               |                                                                          |
| <b>Nobs:</b> Jack of same suit as starter card         | 1               | One Jack in hand matching starter suit.                                  |

**Maximum hand:** 29 points (three 5s and a Jack in hand, starter is the 5 of the same suit as the Jack — allowing 8 fifteens, 6 pairs, one nobs).

## MUGGINS (OPTIONAL)

If a player fails to peg points they earned, the opponent may call “Muggins” and claim those points. Commonly used in competitive play; optional in casual games.

## GAME VARIANTS

**Three-player Cribbage:** 5 cards dealt each, 1 discarded to crib; extra card dealt directly to crib. Play proceeds clockwise. First to 121 wins.

**Four-player Cribbage:** Teams of two (partners sitting opposite). 5 cards each, 1 discarded to crib. Partners’ scores are combined. First team to 121 wins.

**Six-card Cribbage:** Standard two-player game where 6 cards are dealt and 2 are discarded to the crib (same as standard rules above).

## ATTRIBUTION

Cribbage. Attributed to Sir John Suckling, England, early 17th century. Public domain. Standard rules confirmed from Pagat.com and the American Cribbage Congress.